JAMES MITCHELL

Data Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 8 years of experience building and maintaining large-scale data pipelines for fintech and e-commerce sectors. I've spent the last 4 years at Nexus Analytics optimising data workflows that process over 2 billion records daily. I'm most comfortable with Python, Spark, and cloud platforms, though I genuinely enjoy the problem-solving side of data architecture more than any particular technology. Based in Glasgow and looking for roles where I can mentor junior engineers while continuing to work on meaningful data infrastructure challenges.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Scala, SQL, Bash

Big Data Technologies: Apache Spark, Apache Kafka, Apache Airflow

Cloud Platforms: AWS (S3, EC2, RDS, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform, Azure Data Factory

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redshift, Snowflake

Data Pipelines: ETL/ELT design, real-time streaming, batch processing

Tools and Frameworks: Pandas, PySpark, dbt, Tableau, Git

DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD pipelines, GitLab

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer

Nexus Analytics, Glasgow, United Kingdom

nexus-analytics.io

January 2021 - Present

Designed and implemented a real-time data pipeline processing 2 billion events daily using Apache Kafka and Spark, reducing data latency from 6 hours to 15 minutes for critical business metrics.

Migrated legacy batch workflows to cloud-native architecture on AWS, cutting infrastructure costs by 40 percent and improving pipeline reliability to 99.9 percent uptime.

Mentored 3 junior data engineers in Python best practices and data modeling, conducting weekly code reviews and leading technical workshops on Spark optimisation.

Established data quality frameworks using dbt and custom Python validation modules, reducing downstream analytics issues by 65 percent.

Data Engineer

DataFlow Solutions Ltd, Edinburgh, United Kingdom

www.dataflowsolutions.com

June 2018 - December 2020

Built and maintained 40+ ETL pipelines using Apache Airflow and Python, supporting analytics teams across 15 different business units and handling approximately 500 million records daily.

Optimised SQL queries and database indexing strategies, reducing average query execution time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes for key reporting dashboards.

Implemented data governance standards and metadata management system, improving data discoverability and enabling self-service analytics for non-technical stakeholders.

Collaborated with data scientists to productionise machine learning models, creating preprocessing pipelines and feature engineering workflows in PySpark.

Junior Data Engineer

TechVision Consulting, Glasgow, United Kingdom

www.techvision.co.uk

August 2016 - May 2018

Developed Python scripts to extract data from multiple APIs and databases, consolidating disparate sources into a unified data warehouse using PostgreSQL.

Built automated reporting dashboards using Tableau and SQL, serving executive stakeholders and reducing manual reporting time by 20 hours per week.

Assisted in AWS infrastructure setup and maintenance, including S3 bucket configuration, RDS instance management, and cost optimisation.

Wrote comprehensive technical documentation and runbooks for data pipelines, enabling team members to troubleshoot issues independently.

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science

University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Graduated: September 2016

BSc Computer Science

University of Glasgow, Glasgow, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2014

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmitchell-data/spark-pipeline-orchestrator

Production-grade Spark pipeline framework with error handling and monitoring.

github.com/jmitchell-data/kafka-streaming-etl

Real-time ETL solution using Kafka and PySpark for streaming data ingestion.

github.com/jmitchell-data/airflow-dbt-integration

Custom Airflow operators for orchestrating dbt models with data validation.

github.com/jmitchell-data/data-quality-framework

Python framework for implementing data quality checks across multiple sources.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate

Google Cloud Professional Data Engineer

Databricks Certified Associate Data Engineer